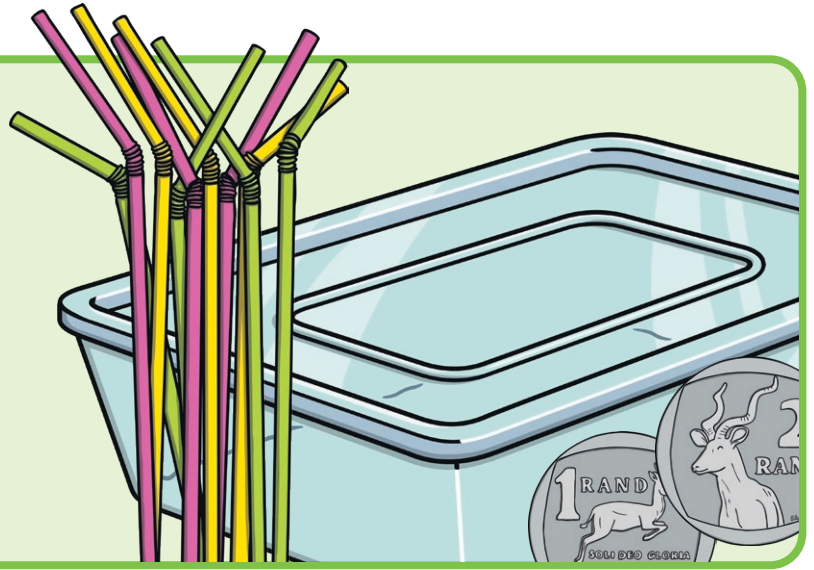


STEM – Building Straw Bridges

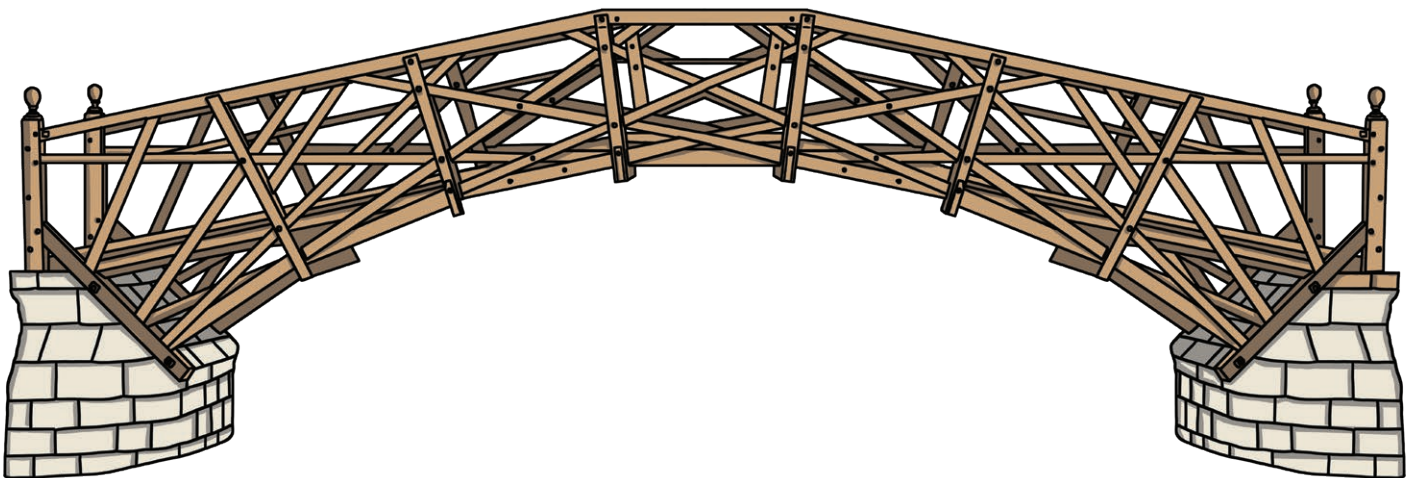
What is needed

- Straws (8)
- A container (lunch box sized)
- Sticky tape
- A small container
- Coins (lots of coins)



Instructions:

1. Use sticky tape to attach four straws along the sides of the container, going lengthwise.
2. Then tape four more straws across these straws, going widthwise on top.
3. Place the smaller container on the straws (the strongest part).
4. Get the children to add coins into the container until everyone has had a turn.
5. The children can do the worksheet available.



What is being taught?

The children are learning about balance and stability as they see how strong the bridge is. This activity introduces engineering principles by showing them and understanding weight distribution and structure.

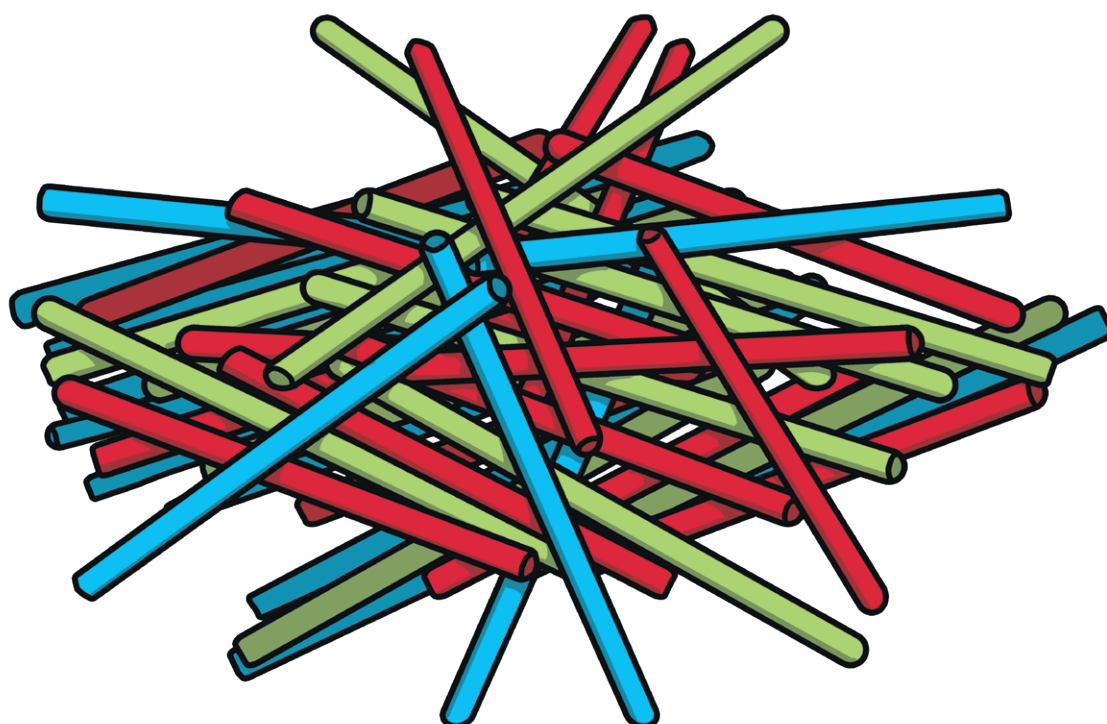
This activity also encourages problem-solving and planning.

Remember:

Tell the children not to put the coins in their mouths.

Key talking points:

- How do they think the bridge should be built?
- What do they predict will happen?
- How many coins do they think the bridge will hold?
- How many coins did it hold?
- Do you think the bridge is strong?



Instructions: Colour in the bridge.

